Amatya (revenue minister), and *Samaharta* (minister of exchequer). Chalukyas divided the state into political divisions for the sake of administration: *Vishayam, Rastram, Nadu* and *Grama*. Epigraphs speak of the officials like *vishayapatis, samantas, gramapohis* and *mahatras*. *Vishayapatis* exercised the power at the behest of the kings. *Samantas* were feudal lords functioning under the control of the state. *Grampohis* and *gramkudas* were village officials. *Mahatras* were the prominent village men.

Provincial and District Administration

Generally, the king appointed his sons as the provincial governors. The governors called themselves *raja, marakka-rajan* and *rajaditya-raja-parameswaran*. Some governors held the title *maha-samanta* and maintained troops. The chief of *vishaya* was *vishayapati.* In turn, *vishaya* was divided into *pukti*. Its head was *pogapati*.

Village Administration

The traditional revenue officials of the villages were called the *nala-kavundas*. The central figure in village administration was *kamunda* or *pokigan* who were appointed by the kings. The village accountant was *karana* and he was otherwise called *gramani*. Law and order of the village was in the hands of a group of people called *mahajanam*. There was a special officer called *mahapurush*, in charge of maintaining order and peace of the village. *Nagarapatis* or *Purapatis* were the officials of the towns.

Religion

The Chalukyas patronised both Saivism and Vaishnavism. They built temples for Siva and Vishnu. Brahmin groups were invited from the Gangetic regions and settled to perform regular pujas and conduct festivals and ceremonies in the temples. Notable Chalukya rulers like Kirtivarman I, Mangalesa (597-609), and Pulikesin II (609-642) performed *yagnas*. They bore titles such as *parama-vaishana* and *parama-maheswara*. Chalukyas gave prominent place to Kartikeyan, the war god. Saiva monasteries became centres for popularising Saivism. Chalukyas patronised heterodox sects also and lavishly donated lands to the Jain centres. Ravikirti, the poet-laureate of Pulikesin II, was a Jain scholar. In the reign of Kirtivarman II a Jain village official built a Jain temple in a place called Annigere. The prince Krishna appointed Gunapatra, a Jain monk, as his master. According to Hiuen Tsang, there were many Buddhist centres in the Chalukya territory wherein more than 5000 followers of the Hinayana and Mahayana sects lived.

Literature and Education

Chalukyas used Sanskrit in pillar inscriptions such as in Aihole and Maha-kudam. A seventh-century inscription of a Chalukya king at Badami mentions Kannada as the local prakrit, meaning the people's language, and Sanskrit as the language of culture. A chieftain of Pulikesin II authored a grammar work *Saptavataram* in Sanskrit.

Chalukya Architecture

Historically, in Deccan, Chalukyas introduced the technique of building temples using soft sandstones as medium. In Badami, two temples are dedicated to Vishnu and one each to Siva and to the Jaina *tirthankaras*. Their temples are grouped into two: excavated cave temples and structural temples. Badami is known for both structural and excavated cave temples. Pattadakal and Aihole are popular for structural temples.

Aihole (Ayyavole)

Built in 634, Aihole, the headquarters of the famous medieval Ayyavole merchants' guild was an important commercial centre. About seventy temples are located in Aihole. The earliest stone-built temple is Lad Khan temple. Its unique trait is a stucco pillar with a big capital distinct from northern style. A temple dedicated to the goddess Durga was built on the model of Buddha Chaitya. It stands on a raised platform in the form of semi-circle. Another temple, dedicated to the

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